smarter BALANCED

Answer Key Printout

Total Items: 26

15-March-2026

Item ID	Grade	Subject	Answer Key	Claim	Target	CCSS	DOK	Type
37169	5	ELA	Student receives one point by selecting: Part A • The Forest Service wanted to keep both the bears and the people safe. AND Part B • How could the Forest Service provide a safe place for bears to fish while people watched?	1	11	5.RI.8	3	HTQ
182841	5	ELA	C	1	10	5.RI.4	1	MC
182843	5	ELA	Part A: A Part B: A,B,E	1	12	5.RI.3	3	EBSR
54960	5	ELA	C	1	2	5.RL.2	2	MC
182915	5	ELA	A,E	1	14	5.L.5	3	MS
182870	5	ELA	D,E	1	2	5.RL.2	2	MS
37161	5	ELA	B,E	1	8	5.RI.1	1	MS

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182878	5	ELA	Part A: A Part B: A	1	4	5.RL.3	3	EBSR
63869	5	ELA	D	1	7	5.L.5a	2	MC
182869	5	ELA	A,D	1	6	5.RL.5	3	MS
37165	5	ELA	See appended rubric	1	9	5.RI.2	3	SA
182867	5	ELA	D	1	7	5.RL.4	2	MC
37163	5	ELA	Part A: D Part B: D	1	9	5.RI.2	2	EBSR
54964	5	ELA	C	1	6	5.RL.5	2	MC
55297	5	ELA	D	1	3	5.RL.4	2	MC
182847	5	ELA	A	1	13	5.RI.5	2	MC
182845	5	ELA	D	1	13	5.RI.5	2	MC
37177	5	ELA	C,D,F	1	14	5.L.5a	2	MS
37977	5	ELA	See appended rubric	1	11	5.RI.1	3	SA
182868	5	ELA	B,E	1	3	5.RL.4	2	MS
182837	5	ELA	D	1	8	5.RI.1	2	MC
37175	5	ELA	D	1	13	5.RI.5	3	MC
182839	5	ELA	Part A: A Part B: B,E	1	9	5.RI.2	2	EBSR

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182879	5	ELA	Student earns one point by selecting: • It would not only lift weights, but it would turn all kinds of machinery. AND • It would draw our wagons, it would push our ships, it would plow and sow, it would spin and weave.	1	1	5.RL.1	2	HTQ
37171	5	ELA	A,B,C,D	1	12	5.RI.3	4	MS
182871	5	ELA	See appended rubric	1	4	5.RL.3	3	SA

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Appended Rubric :

#37165

Points	Description
2	A response: • Gives sufficient evidence of the ability to determine/summarize the author's message/main idea, or to explain the support for a main idea • Includes specific examples/details that make clear reference to the text • Adequately explains the author's message/main idea or explanation with clearly relevant information based on the text
1	A response: • Gives limited evidence of the ability to determine/summarize the author's message/main idea, or to explain the support for a main idea • Includes vague/limited examples/details that make reference to the text • Explains the author's message/main idea or explanation with vague/limited information based on the text

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0	A response: • Gives no evidence of the ability to determine/summarize the author's message/main idea, or to explain the support for a main idea OR • Gives the author's message/main idea or explanation, but includes no examples or no examples/details that make reference to the text OR • Gives the author's message/main idea or explanation, but includes no explanation or no relevant information from the text

#37977

Points	Description
2	A response: • Gives sufficient evidence of the ability to make a clear inference/conclusion • Includes specific examples/details that make clear reference to the text • Adequately explains inference/conclusion with clearly relevant information based on the text

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1	A response: • Gives limited evidence of the ability to make an inference/conclusion • Includes vague/limited examples/details that make reference to the text • Explains inference/conclusion with vague/limited information based on the text
0	A response: • Gives no evidence of the ability to make an inference/conclusion OR • Gives an inference /conclusion but includes no examples or no examples/ details that make reference to the text OR • Gives an inference/conclusion but includes no explanation or relevant information from the text

#182871

Points	Description
2	A full-credit response: • Gives sufficient evidence of the ability to make a clear inference/draw a conclusion • Includes specific examples/details that make clear reference to the text • Adequately explains inference/conclusion with clearly relevant information based on the text

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1	A partial-credit response: • Gives limited evidence of the ability to make an inference/draw a conclusion • Includes vague/limited examples/details that make reference to the text • Provides a limited explanation of the inference/conclusion with vague/limited information based on the text
0	A no-credit response: • Gives no evidence of the ability to make an inference/draw a conclusion OR • Gives an inference/conclusion but includes no examples or no examples/details that make reference to the text OR • Gives an inference/draws a conclusion but includes no explanation or relevant information from the text

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#1 - 37169

Read the text and answer the questions.

Let the Bears Fish
by Carolyn Short

People come to Hyder, Alaska, every summer just as the salmon arrive to lay their eggs on the gravelly stream bottom and die. The bears come to feed on the spawning salmon and to put on the weight they need to survive the winter. The people come to watch the bears. But visitors haven't always had a safe viewing platform. In the past, there was only a short, unprotected platform. To get to it, people had to walk along the bears' paths. Sometimes the bears climbed onto the platform. Over the years, the number of visitors grew. They didn't all fit on the platform, so they wandered everywhere. Since the bears wandered everywhere, too, many visitors were in danger. The Forest Service hired people to keep the visitors and bears apart.

But there were still problems. Many visitors didn't realize that bears are wild animals. Some brought food. Others got too close when they took pictures. Some set up chairs on the bears' paths.

Watching people watching bears turned into one big headache. What could be done?

How could the Forest Service provide a safe place for bears to fish while people watched? How could they build a new platform that wouldn't block the bears' paths? How could they avoid destroying the brush the bears use for cover?

If the area were made safer, more people would come. Where would they park? Photographers worried that if they had to take pictures from a platform, vibrations from people walking would ruin their photographs. The Forest Service came up with a plan. Along the stream, they would build a platform stretching nearly the length of one and a half football fields.

The platform would be from six to twelve feet off the ground so that bears could walk under it. A wide cap atop the railing would give people a place to lean and a steady base for taking pictures. By winding the platform through the trees, the builders could avoid cutting them down.

As a landscape architect with the Forest Service, my husband helped design the viewing platform and oversaw its construction.

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Every week, he would return home with tales of the bears he had seen. Our family couldn't wait to see this place!

In August, when we arrived in Hyder, we drove six miles to the viewing area. It was nearly 7 P.M. when we parked the car and walked along the fenced walkway leading from the new, larger parking lot to the platform.

About two hundred people had arrived before us. They lined the platform, watching and chatting. Suddenly the crowd hushed. Someone whispered, "It's The Brat!" I watched as this grizzly caught a big salmon and dragged it up onto the grass.

The best time to watch the bears is in the early morning and evening, but the next day we arrived in the middle of the day and spotted a black bear walking along the stream. Both grizzly and black bears feed here, but black bears usually come when grizzlies aren't around. We heard that a well-known grizzly called Aussie was napping near a pond on the other side of the platform. We waited to see if he would appear. Before long a snout pushed through the brush. Aussie stepped off the bank and into the pond. Only his head showed as he paddled. Reaching the muddy shallows, he turned onto his side and batted at a nearby log. Rolling over, he swam toward the old dike road, where people used to gather. Water droplets glistened on his fur as he climbed out and padded down the road.

Cameras clicked furiously. Turning left, Aussie walked under the platform. I lost sight of him until he waded into the stream. Water sprayed in white plumes as salmon flipped out of his way. Aussie pounced, pinning a salmon against the gravel with his massive paw.

He carried the squirming salmon in his mouth to the opposite shore. After dropping the salmon in the grass, he pushed down on its belly with one paw. Reddish streams of fish eggs spurted out. Aussie left the salmon and licked the tasty roe off the grass and gravel.

Aussie continued eating his lunch as dozens of people watched. He never looked up at us looking down at him. Did he know we were there? I don't know, but I was glad he could fish in peace while we watched in safety from the new viewing platform.

"Let the Bears Fish" by Carolyn Short, from *Highlights for Children*. Copyright © 2004 by Highlights for Children, Inc. Reprinted by permission of the publisher.

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#1 - 37169

The question has two parts. First, answer part A. Then, answer part B.

Part A

Read the sentences from the text.

The Forest Service hired people to keep the visitors and bears apart. How could the Forest Service provide a safe place for bears to fish while people watched? Along the stream, they would build a platform stretching nearly the length of one and a half football fields. By winding the platform through the trees, the builders could avoid cutting them down.

Click on the statement that **best** describes an inference that can be made about the Forest Service's intentions for the park.

A. The Forest Service wanted the fish to remain in the stream.

B. The Forest Service wanted to keep both the bears and the people safe.

C. The Forest Service wanted to create meaningful jobs for their employees.

Part B

Click on the sentence from the text that **best** supports your answer in part A.

The Forest Service hired people to keep the visitors and bears apart. How could the Forest Service provide a safe place for bears to fish while people watched? Along the stream, they would build a platform stretching nearly the length of one and a half football fields. By winding the platform through the trees, the builders could avoid cutting them down.

#2 - 182841 , #3 - 182843

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Read the text and answer the questions.

Cuisine and Etiquette

by the Peace Corps

Cuisine and Etiquette in Zambia

Zambia's staple food is maize (corn), and Zambians eat maize in several ways. When the corn is ripe but still green, it can be roasted or boiled. When it is dry and hard, it can be fried or boiled. It can also be pounded slightly to remove the outside layer and boiled either by itself or mixed with beans or groundnuts (peanuts). At times the maize is ground to a size a little bigger than rice and is cooked like rice. Finally, we have the fine cornmeal, which is called mealie-meal in Zambia. This is used for making nsima, the most popular meal. Nsima is steamed cornmeal.

Meat from cows, goats, sheep, and fish is used in sauces over nsima. There are also a lot of vegetables put in sauces, such as leaves from beans, okra, cow peas, pumpkins, and cassava. Other vegetables eaten almost daily include onions and tomatoes.

All the cooking is done by the wife. Nsima is usually prepared for lunch and dinner and not for breakfast. In a traditional setting, boys from the age of seven eat with the man of the house.

The mother eats with the girls and the younger boys. This is because all of the children below the age of seven are under the guidance of their mother. Almost all learning takes place through daily activities in the home. The mother, who is in charge of the kids' learning, has to take care of their learning at meal time. This is changing, especially in towns and cities. The trend now is that members of the family all eat together.

Before eating, everybody washes hands in order of the status of the members of the family: father first, then mother, and others follow according to their ages. One of the younger children, boy or girl, passes a water dish around for others to wash their hands. If a visitor happens to have a meal with the family, he or she is given the honor of washing first.

It is rude to talk very much or loudly while eating. After eating, the family members wash their hands again in the same order. The wife and the young ones clear the table. Belching after a meal used to be a compliment, but it is not nowadays.

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Cuisine and Etiquette in Uganda

In Uganda, the staple food is matoke (cooking bananas). Other food crops include cassava (manioc), sweet potatoes, white potatoes, yams, beans, peas, groundnuts (peanuts), cabbage, onions, pumpkins, and tomatoes. Some fruits, such as oranges, pawpaws (papayas), lemons, and pineapples, are also grown.

Most people, except for a few who live in the city centers, produce their own food. The responsibility for preparing the family's meals belongs solely to women and girls in the home. Men and boys of age 12 and above are not even expected to sit in the kitchen, which is separate from the main house. Cooking is done on an open fire using wood for fuel.

Most families eat two meals a day. The two meals are lunch and supper. Breakfast is just a cup of tea or a bowl of porridge.

When a meal is ready, all members of the household wash their hands and sit down on [floor] mats. Hands have to be washed before and after the meal because most Ugandans eat with their hands. At mealtime everybody is welcome; visitors and neighbors who drop in are expected to join the family at a meal.

Food is served by women. They cut it up into small pieces for each member of the family. Sauce, which is usually a stew with vegetables, beans, butter, salt, and curry powder, is served to each person on a plate. Sometimes fish or beef stew is served.

Normally a short prayer is said before the family starts eating. During the meal, children talk only when asked a question. It is bad manners to reach for salt or a spoon. It is better to ask someone sitting close to it to pass it. It is also bad manners to leave the room while others are still eating. Everyone respects the meal by staying seated until the meal is over. Leaning on the left hand or stretching ones legs while at a meal is a sign of disrespect and is not tolerated.

People usually drink water at the end of the meal. It is considered odd to drink water while eating.

When the meal is finished, everyone in turn gives a compliment to the mother by saying, "Thank you for preparing the meal, madam." No dessert is served after the meal. Fruits like papaw, pineapple, or sweet bananas are normally eaten as a snack between meals.

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Excerpt from "Worldwise Window" by the Peace Corps. In the public domain.

#2 - 182841

First, read the sentence from “Cuisine and Etiquette in Zambia.”

Zambia's staple food is maize (corn), and Zambians eat maize in several ways.

Now read the sentence from “Cuisine and Etiquette in Uganda.”

In Uganda, the staple food is matoke (cooking bananas).

Which dictionary definition **best** defines staple as it is used in both texts?

A. a metal wire fastener

B. a quality of cloth fiber

C. important part of the diet

D. raw material for manufacture

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#3 - 182843

The following question has two parts. First, answer part A. Then, answer part B.

How does the information in “Cuisine and Etiquette in Uganda” help the reader understand the differing roles of males and females in “Cuisine and Etiquette in Zambia”?

Part A

A. by explaining that in Uganda men are not expected to sit in the kitchen

B. by explaining that in Uganda the kitchen is separate from the rest of the house

C. by explaining that in Uganda only children are not allowed to speak during meals

D. by explaining that in Uganda neither men or women are allowed to leave until everyone has finished eating

Which sentences from texts, “Cuisine and Etiquette in Zambia” and “Cuisine and Etiquette in Uganda,” **best** support your answer in part A? Select **three** answers.

Part B

A. “All the cooking is done by the wife.”

B. “In a traditional setting, boys from the age of seven eat with the man of the house.”

C. “The trend now is that members of the family all eat together.”

D. “Most people, except for a few who live in the city centers, produce their own food.”

E. “The responsibility for preparing the family's meals belongs solely to women and girls in the home.”

F. “Most families eat two meals a day.”

#4 - 54960

Read the text and answer the question.

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Mouse and Tapir
A story from South America

Every day Tapir would go off into the forest for hours at a time. Sometimes when she returned, she smelled like something sweet. Other times she would burp. Mouse began to get suspicious and called a meeting of all the other animals and birds.

"Tapir's finding something good to eat, and she's not sharing it with us," said Mouse.

"We'll follow her tomorrow," someone suggested.

"Mouse should go alone," said someone else. "He's the smallest. Tapir won't see him." So it was decided.

When Tapir set off into the forest the next morning, Mouse scurried quietly after her. After a very long walk, Mouse saw Tapir enter a clearing. When Mouse got closer, he couldn't believe his eyes. In the middle of the clearing was an enormous tree, the biggest tree in the world. It had hundreds of huge branches, and each branch was heavy with foods Mouse had never seen before—ripe bananas and plantains, mangoes and papayas, squashes and corn, pumpkins and pomegranates, sweet potatoes and yams—all kinds of edible things. It was the Food Tree.

And there was Tapir, greedily eating the ripe fruits that had fallen to the ground.

Mouse hurried back to the village to tell the others what he had discovered. They all stopped what they were doing and followed Mouse to the Food Tree. Tapir was lying at its base, still eating. Even her chin hairs were dripping with juice.

"Why didn't you tell us about this tree?" asked Mouse. But Tapir didn't answer. She just grunted.

Most of the food was too high to reach, so everyone gathered in a circle to decide what to do. They had no choice but to cut down the tree. They began right away, the birds pecking with their beaks and the animals digging with their claws and gnawing with their teeth at the massive trunk. Tapir didn't help at all. She was too full to move.

Finally, after two whole days and two whole nights of work, the Food Tree swayed for a moment, then tottered. There was a deafening

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crunch as the Food Tree began to fall. Broken branches laden with fruit came tumbling down. When the gigantic trunk hit the ground, the whole world shook.

After everything had settled, the birds and animals gathered again. Mouse noticed that where a banana branch had fallen, several banana trees had sprouted in the ground. Banana trees had never existed before. Tapir pointed out some corn growing a short distance away. There had never been corn plants before. Fruits and vegetables that had never grown anywhere but on the Food Tree were suddenly growing everywhere.

The fruits of the Food Tree still grow to this very day, food for all the animals and people of the world.

"Mouse and Tapir" by Jan Thornhill from *Folktales and Animal Legends from Around the World*. Copyright © 1993 Maple Tree Press.

#4 - 54960

Which statement **best** summarizes a theme of the text?

A. Sharing things with others can lead to good friendships.

B. Greed tends to make you lose the things you wanted most.

C. Difficult problems can require careful teamwork to be solved.

D. Keeping secrets from your friends can cause them to doubt you.

#5 - 182915

Read the text and answer the questions.

Cuisine and Etiquette

by the Peace Corps

Cuisine and Etiquette in Zambia

Zambia's staple food is maize (corn), and Zambians eat maize in several ways. When the corn is ripe but still green, it can be roasted or boiled. When it is dry and hard, it can be fried or boiled. It can also be pounded slightly to remove the outside layer and boiled either by itself

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or mixed with beans or groundnuts (peanuts). At times the maize is ground to a size a little bigger than rice and is cooked like rice. Finally, we have the fine cornmeal, which is called mealie-meal in Zambia. This is used for making nsima, the most popular meal. Nsima is steamed cornmeal.

Meat from cows, goats, sheep, and fish is used in sauces over nsima. There are also a lot of vegetables put in sauces, such as leaves from beans, okra, cow peas, pumpkins, and cassava. Other vegetables eaten almost daily include onions and tomatoes.

All the cooking is done by the wife. Nsima is usually prepared for lunch and dinner and not for breakfast. In a traditional setting, boys from the age of seven eat with the man of the house.

The mother eats with the girls and the younger boys. This is because all of the children below the age of seven are under the guidance of their mother. Almost all learning takes place through daily activities in the home. The mother, who is in charge of the kids' learning, has to take care of their learning at meal time. This is changing, especially in towns and cities. The trend now is that members of the family all eat together.

Before eating, everybody washes hands in order of the status of the members of the family: father first, then mother, and others follow according to their ages. One of the younger children, boy or girl, passes a water dish around for others to wash their hands. If a visitor happens to have a meal with the family, he or she is given the honor of washing first.

It is rude to talk very much or loudly while eating. After eating, the family members wash their hands again in the same order. The wife and the young ones clear the table. Belching after a meal used to be a compliment, but it is not nowadays.

Cuisine and Etiquette in Uganda

In Uganda, the staple food is matoke (cooking bananas). Other food crops include cassava (manioc), sweet potatoes, white potatoes, yams, beans, peas, groundnuts (peanuts), cabbage, onions, pumpkins, and tomatoes. Some fruits, such as oranges, pawpaws (papayas), lemons, and pineapples, are also grown.

Most people, except for a few who live in the city centers, produce their own food. The responsibility for preparing the family's meals belongs solely to women and girls in the home. Men and boys of age

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12 and above are not even expected to sit in the kitchen, which is separate from the main house. Cooking is done on an open fire using wood for fuel.

Most families eat two meals a day. The two meals are lunch and supper. Breakfast is just a cup of tea or a bowl of porridge.

When a meal is ready, all members of the household wash their hands and sit down on [floor] mats. Hands have to be washed before and after the meal because most Ugandans eat with their hands. At mealtime everybody is welcome; visitors and neighbors who drop in are expected to join the family at a meal.

Food is served by women. They cut it up into small pieces for each member of the family. Sauce, which is usually a stew with vegetables, beans, butter, salt, and curry powder, is served to each person on a plate. Sometimes fish or beef stew is served.

Normally a short prayer is said before the family starts eating. During the meal, children talk only when asked a question. It is bad manners to reach for salt or a spoon. It is better to ask someone sitting close to it to pass it. It is also bad manners to leave the room while others are still eating. Everyone respects the meal by staying seated until the meal is over. Leaning on the left hand or stretching ones legs while at a meal is a sign of disrespect and is not tolerated.

People usually drink water at the end of the meal. It is considered odd to drink water while eating.

When the meal is finished, everyone in turn gives a compliment to the mother by saying, "Thank you for preparing the meal, madam." No dessert is served after the meal. Fruits like papaw, pineapple, or sweet bananas are normally eaten as a snack between meals.

Excerpt from "Worldwise Window" by the Peace Corps. In the public domain.

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#5 - 182915

Read the sentence from “Cuisine and Etiquette in Zambia.”

Belching after a meal used to be a compliment, but it is not nowadays.

Based on the information in “Cuisine and Etiquette in Uganda,” what does the author mean by the word compliment? Select **two** answers.

A. The author is suggesting a social way of showing politeness.

B. The author is telling the reader that the mother is a good cook.

C. The author is demonstrating that the family show the mother love.

D. The author is making light of the women's efforts in meal preparation.

E. The author is suggesting that the mother needs to be thanked for her hard work.

F. The author is complaining that the mother doesn't do much work except prepare meals.

#6 - 182870

Read the passage and answer the questions.

James Watt and the Teakettle
by James Baldwin

A little boy from Scotland was sitting in his grandmother's kitchen. He was watching the red flames in the wide open fireplace and quietly wondering about the causes of things. Indeed, he was always wondering and always wanting to know.

"Grandma," he presently asked, "what makes the fire burn?"

This was not the first time he had puzzled his grandmother with questions that she could not answer. So she went on with her preparations for supper and paid no heed to his query.

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Above the fire an old-fashioned teakettle was hanging. The water within it was beginning to bubble. A thin cloud of steam was rising from the spout. Soon the lid began to rattle and shake. The hot vapor puffed out at a furious rate. Yet when the lad peeped under the lid he could see nothing.

"Grandma, what is in the teakettle?" he asked.

"Water, my child—nothing but water."

"But I know there is something else. There is something in there that lifts the lid and makes it rattle."

The grandmother laughed. "Oh, that is only steam," she said. "You can see it coming out of the spout and puffing up under the lid."

"But you said there was nothing but water in the kettle. How did the steam get under the lid?"

"Why, my dear, it comes out of the hot water. The hot water makes it." The grandmother was beginning to feel puzzled.

The lad lifted the lid and peeped inside again. He could see nothing but the bubbling water. The steam was not visible until after it was fairly out of the kettle.

"How odd!" he said. "The steam must be very strong to lift the heavy iron lid. Grandma, how much water did you put into the kettle?"

"About a quart, Jamie."

"Well, if the steam from so little water is so strong, why would not the steam from a great deal of water be a great deal stronger? Why couldn't it be made to lift a much greater weight? Why couldn't it be made to turn wheels?"

The grandmother made no reply. These questions of Jamie's were more puzzling than profitable, she thought. She went about her work silently, and Jamie sat still in his place and studied the teakettle.

How to understand the power that is in steam, and how to make it do other things than rattle the lids of teakettles—that was the problem which James Watt, the inquisitive Scottish boy, set himself to solve. Day after day he thought about it, and evening after evening he sat by his grandmother's fireside and watched the thin, white vapor come out

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of the teakettle and lose itself in the yawning black throat of the chimney. The idea grew with him as he grew into manhood, and by long study he began to reason upon it to some purpose.

"There is a wonderful power in steam," he said to himself. "There was never a giant who had so much strength. If we only knew how to harness that power, there is no end to the things it might do for us. It would not only lift weights, but it would turn all kinds of machinery. It would draw our wagons, it would push our ships, it would plow and sow, it would spin and weave. For thousands of years men have been working alongside of this power, never dreaming that it might be made their servant. But how can this be done? That is the question."

He tried one experiment after another. He failed again and again, but from each failure he learned something new. Men laughed at him. "How ridiculous," they said, "to think that steam can be made to run machinery!"

But James Watt persevered, and in the end was able to give to the world the first successful form of the steam engine. Thus, from the study of so simple a thing as a common teakettle, the most useful of all modern inventions was finally produced.

"James Watt and the Teakettle" by James Baldwin from *Thirty More Famous Stories*. In the public domain.

#6 - 182870

Select the **two** sentences that should be included in a summary of the last four paragraphs of the passage.

A. James was from Scotland.

B. James knew steam could power ships.

C. James continued to live with his grandmother.

D. James kept thinking about uses for steam as he grew up.

E. James failed many times but kept learning from his mistakes.

F. James felt badly when others laughed at his experiments.

#7 - 37161

Read the text and answer the questions.

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Let the Bears Fish
by Carolyn Short

People come to Hyder, Alaska, every summer just as the salmon arrive to lay their eggs on the gravelly stream bottom and die. The bears come to feed on the spawning salmon and to put on the weight they need to survive the winter. The people come to watch the bears. But visitors haven't always had a safe viewing platform. In the past, there was only a short, unprotected platform. To get to it, people had to walk along the bears' paths. Sometimes the bears climbed onto the platform. Over the years, the number of visitors grew. They didn't all fit on the platform, so they wandered everywhere. Since the bears wandered everywhere, too, many visitors were in danger. The Forest Service hired people to keep the visitors and bears apart.

But there were still problems. Many visitors didn't realize that bears are wild animals. Some brought food. Others got too close when they took pictures. Some set up chairs on the bears' paths.

Watching people watching bears turned into one big headache. What could be done?

How could the Forest Service provide a safe place for bears to fish while people watched? How could they build a new platform that wouldn't block the bears' paths? How could they avoid destroying the brush the bears use for cover?

If the area were made safer, more people would come. Where would they park? Photographers worried that if they had to take pictures from a platform, vibrations from people walking would ruin their photographs. The Forest Service came up with a plan. Along the stream, they would build a platform stretching nearly the length of one and a half football fields.

The platform would be from six to twelve feet off the ground so that bears could walk under it. A wide cap atop the railing would give people a place to lean and a steady base for taking pictures. By winding the platform through the trees, the builders could avoid cutting them down.

As a landscape architect with the Forest Service, my husband helped design the viewing platform and oversaw its construction.

Every week, he would return home with tales of the bears he had seen. Our family couldn't wait to see this place!

In August, when we arrived in Hyder, we drove six miles to the viewing area. It was nearly 7 P.M. when we parked the car and walked along the fenced walkway leading from the new, larger parking lot to the platform.

About two hundred people had arrived before us. They lined the

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platform, watching and chatting. Suddenly the crowd hushed. Someone whispered, “It’s The Brat!” I watched as this grizzly caught a big salmon and dragged it up onto the grass.

The best time to watch the bears is in the early morning and evening, but the next day we arrived in the middle of the day and spotted a black bear walking along the stream. Both grizzly and black bears feed here, but black bears usually come when grizzlies aren’t around. We heard that a well-known grizzly called Aussie was napping near a pond on the other side of the platform. We waited to see if he would appear. Before long a snout pushed through the brush. Aussie stepped off the bank and into the pond. Only his head showed as he paddled. Reaching the muddy shallows, he turned onto his side and batted at a nearby log. Rolling over, he swam toward the old dike road, where people used to gather. Water droplets glistened on his fur as he climbed out and padded down the road.

Cameras clicked furiously. Turning left, Aussie walked under the platform. I lost sight of him until he waded into the stream. Water sprayed in white plumes as salmon flipped out of his way. Aussie pounced, pinning a salmon against the gravel with his massive paw.

He carried the squirming salmon in his mouth to the opposite shore. After dropping the salmon in the grass, he pushed down on its belly with one paw. Reddish streams of fish eggs spurted out. Aussie left the salmon and licked the tasty roe off the grass and gravel.

Aussie continued eating his lunch as dozens of people watched. He never looked up at us looking down at him. Did he know we were there? I don’t know, but I was glad he could fish in peace while we watched in safety from the new viewing platform.

"Let the Bears Fish" by Carolyn Short, from *Highlights for Children*. Copyright © 2004 by Highlights for Children, Inc. Reprinted by permission of the publisher.

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#7 - 37161

Read this conclusion about the text.

An increasing number of people come to Hyder, Alaska, each summer.

Select **two** details from the text that **best** support this conclusion.

A. In the past, there was only a short, unprotected platform.

B. They didn't all fit on the platform, so they wandered everywhere.

C. Many visitors didn’t realize that bears are wild animals.

D. Since the bears wandered everywhere, too, many visitors were in danger.

E. Along the stream, they would build a platform stretching nearly the length of one and a half football fields.

#8 - 182878

Read the passage and answer the questions.

James Watt and the Teakettle
by James Baldwin

A little boy from Scotland was sitting in his grandmother's kitchen. He was watching the red flames in the wide open fireplace and quietly wondering about the causes of things. Indeed, he was always wondering and always wanting to know.

"Grandma," he presently asked, "what makes the fire burn?"

This was not the first time he had puzzled his grandmother with questions that she could not answer. So she went on with her preparations for supper and paid no heed to his query.

Above the fire an old-fashioned teakettle was hanging. The water within it was beginning to bubble. A thin cloud of steam was rising from the spout. Soon the lid began to rattle and shake. The hot vapor puffed out at a furious rate. Yet when the lad peeped under the lid he could see nothing.

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"Grandma, what is in the teakettle?" he asked.

"Water, my child—nothing but water."

"But I know there is something else. There is something in there that lifts the lid and makes it rattle."

The grandmother laughed. "Oh, that is only steam," she said. "You can see it coming out of the spout and puffing up under the lid."

"But you said there was nothing but water in the kettle. How did the steam get under the lid?"

"Why, my dear, it comes out of the hot water. The hot water makes it." The grandmother was beginning to feel puzzled.

The lad lifted the lid and peeped inside again. He could see nothing but the bubbling water. The steam was not visible until after it was fairly out of the kettle.

"How odd!" he said. "The steam must be very strong to lift the heavy iron lid. Grandma, how much water did you put into the kettle?"

"About a quart, Jamie."

"Well, if the steam from so little water is so strong, why would not the steam from a great deal of water be a great deal stronger? Why couldn't it be made to lift a much greater weight? Why couldn't it be made to turn wheels?"

The grandmother made no reply. These questions of Jamie's were more puzzling than profitable, she thought. She went about her work silently, and Jamie sat still in his place and studied the teakettle.

How to understand the power that is in steam, and how to make it do other things than rattle the lids of teakettles—that was the problem which James Watt, the inquisitive Scottish boy, set himself to solve. Day after day he thought about it, and evening after evening he sat by his grandmother's fireside and watched the thin, white vapor come out of the teakettle and lose itself in the yawning black throat of the chimney. The idea grew with him as he grew into manhood, and by long study he began to reason upon it to some purpose.

"There is a wonderful power in steam," he said to himself. "There was never a giant who had so much strength. If we only knew how to

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harness that power, there is no end to the things it might do for us. It would not only lift weights, but it would turn all kinds of machinery. It would draw our wagons, it would push our ships, it would plow and sow, it would spin and weave. For thousands of years men have been working alongside of this power, never dreaming that it might be made their servant. But how can this be done? That is the question."

He tried one experiment after another. He failed again and again, but from each failure he learned something new. Men laughed at him. "How ridiculous," they said, "to think that steam can be made to run machinery!"

But James Watt persevered, and in the end was able to give to the world the first successful form of the steam engine. Thus, from the study of so simple a thing as a common teakettle, the most useful of all modern inventions was finally produced.

"James Watt and the Teakettle" by James Baldwin from *Thirty More Famous Stories*. In the public domain.

#8 - 182878

The following question has two parts. First, answer part A. Then, answer part B.

What conclusion about James is supported by the text?

Part A

A. James enjoyed learning new things.

B. James feared being defeated by his experiments.

C. James believed he was more intelligent than others.

D. James felt badly about his grandmother ignoring his questions.

Which sentence from the passage **best** supports your answer in part A?

Part B

A. “Indeed, he was always wondering and always wanting to know.”

B. “The lad lifted the lid and peeped inside again.”

C. “Jamie sat still in his place.”

D. “He failed again and again.”

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Read the text and answer the question.

Mouse and Tapir
A story from South America

Every day Tapir would go off into the forest for hours at a time. Sometimes when she returned, she smelled like something sweet. Other times she would burp. Mouse began to get suspicious and called a meeting of all the other animals and birds.

"Tapir's finding something good to eat, and she's not sharing it with us," said Mouse.

"We'll follow her tomorrow," someone suggested.

"Mouse should go alone," said someone else. "He's the smallest. Tapir won't see him." So it was decided.

When Tapir set off into the forest the next morning, Mouse scurried quietly after her. After a very long walk, Mouse saw Tapir enter a clearing. When Mouse got closer, he couldn't believe his eyes. In the middle of the clearing was an enormous tree, the biggest tree in the world. It had hundreds of huge branches, and each branch was heavy with foods Mouse had never seen before—ripe bananas and plantains, mangoes and papayas, squashes and corn, pumpkins and pomegranates, sweet potatoes and yams—all kinds of edible things. It was the Food Tree.

And there was Tapir, greedily eating the ripe fruits that had fallen to the ground.

Mouse hurried back to the village to tell the others what he had discovered. They all stopped what they were doing and followed Mouse to the Food Tree. Tapir was lying at its base, still eating. Even her chin hairs were dripping with juice.

"Why didn't you tell us about this tree?" asked Mouse. But Tapir didn't answer. She just grunted.

Most of the food was too high to reach, so everyone gathered in a circle to decide what to do. They had no choice but to cut down the

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tree. They began right away, the birds pecking with their beaks and the animals digging with their claws and gnawing with their teeth at the massive trunk. Tapir didn't help at all. She was too full to move.

Finally, after two whole days and two whole nights of work, the Food Tree swayed for a moment, then tottered. There was a deafening *crunch* as the Food Tree began to fall. Broken branches laden with fruit came tumbling down. When the gigantic trunk hit the ground, the whole world shook.

After everything had settled, the birds and animals gathered again. Mouse noticed that where a banana branch had fallen, several banana trees had sprouted in the ground. Banana trees had never existed before. Tapir pointed out some corn growing a short distance away. There had never been corn plants before. Fruits and vegetables that had never grown anywhere but on the Food Tree were suddenly growing everywhere.

The fruits of the Food Tree still grow to this very day, food for all the animals and people of the world.

"Mouse and Tapir" by Jan Thornhill from *Folktales and Animal Legends from Around the World*. Copyright © 1993 Maple Tree Press.

#9 - 63869

Read the sentence from the text.

When the gigantic trunk hit the ground, the whole world shook.

Which statement **best** describes what the phrase the whole world shook in the sentence adds to the tone of the text.

A. The phrase adds a cheerful tone to the text.

B. The phrase adds a hopeless tone to the text.

C. The phrase adds a nervous tone to the text.

D. The phrase adds an exciting tone to the text.

#10 - 182869

Read the passage and answer the questions.

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James Watt and the Teakettle
by James Baldwin

A little boy from Scotland was sitting in his grandmother's kitchen. He was watching the red flames in the wide open fireplace and quietly wondering about the causes of things. Indeed, he was always wondering and always wanting to know.

"Grandma," he presently asked, "what makes the fire burn?"

This was not the first time he had puzzled his grandmother with questions that she could not answer. So she went on with her preparations for supper and paid no heed to his query.

Above the fire an old-fashioned teakettle was hanging. The water within it was beginning to bubble. A thin cloud of steam was rising from the spout. Soon the lid began to rattle and shake. The hot vapor puffed out at a furious rate. Yet when the lad peeped under the lid he could see nothing.

"Grandma, what is in the teakettle?" he asked.

"Water, my child—nothing but water."

"But I know there is something else. There is something in there that lifts the lid and makes it rattle."

The grandmother laughed. "Oh, that is only steam," she said. "You can see it coming out of the spout and puffing up under the lid."

"But you said there was nothing but water in the kettle. How did the steam get under the lid?"

"Why, my dear, it comes out of the hot water. The hot water makes it." The grandmother was beginning to feel puzzled.

The lad lifted the lid and peeped inside again. He could see nothing but the bubbling water. The steam was not visible until after it was fairly out of the kettle.

"How odd!" he said. "The steam must be very strong to lift the heavy iron lid. Grandma, how much water did you put into the kettle?"

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"About a quart, Jamie."

"Well, if the steam from so little water is so strong, why would not the steam from a great deal of water be a great deal stronger? Why couldn't it be made to lift a much greater weight? Why couldn't it be made to turn wheels?"

The grandmother made no reply. These questions of Jamie's were more puzzling than profitable, she thought. She went about her work silently, and Jamie sat still in his place and studied the teakettle.

How to understand the power that is in steam, and how to make it do other things than rattle the lids of teakettles—that was the problem which James Watt, the inquisitive Scottish boy, set himself to solve. Day after day he thought about it, and evening after evening he sat by his grandmother's fireside and watched the thin, white vapor come out of the teakettle and lose itself in the yawning black throat of the chimney. The idea grew with him as he grew into manhood, and by long study he began to reason upon it to some purpose.

"There is a wonderful power in steam," he said to himself. "There was never a giant who had so much strength. If we only knew how to harness that power, there is no end to the things it might do for us. It would not only lift weights, but it would turn all kinds of machinery. It would draw our wagons, it would push our ships, it would plow and sow, it would spin and weave. For thousands of years men have been working alongside of this power, never dreaming that it might be made their servant. But how can this be done? That is the question."

He tried one experiment after another. He failed again and again, but from each failure he learned something new. Men laughed at him. "How ridiculous," they said, "to think that steam can be made to run machinery!"

But James Watt persevered, and in the end was able to give to the world the first successful form of the steam engine. Thus, from the study of so simple a thing as a common teakettle, the most useful of all modern inventions was finally produced.

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#10 - 182869

How does the first paragraph affect the plot? Select **two** choices.

A. It introduces the main character.

B. It gives an idea of the age of the boy.

C. It gives details of the setting of the passage.

D. It shows that the boy is curious about things.

E. It shows that the boy is very quiet and thoughtful.

F. It describes the relationship between the boy and his grandmother.

#11 - 37165

Read the text and answer the questions.

Let the Bears Fish
by Carolyn Short

People come to Hyder, Alaska, every summer just as the salmon arrive to lay their eggs on the gravelly stream bottom and die. The bears come to feed on the spawning salmon and to put on the weight they need to survive the winter. The people come to watch the bears. But visitors haven't always had a safe viewing platform. In the past, there was only a short, unprotected platform. To get to it, people had to walk along the bears' paths. Sometimes the bears climbed onto the platform. Over the years, the number of visitors grew. They didn't all fit on the platform, so they wandered everywhere. Since the bears wandered everywhere, too, many visitors were in danger. The Forest Service hired people to keep the visitors and bears apart.

But there were still problems. Many visitors didn't realize that bears are wild animals. Some brought food. Others got too close when they took pictures. Some set up chairs on the bears' paths.

Watching people watching bears turned into one big headache. What could be done?

How could the Forest Service provide a safe place for bears to fish while people watched? How could they build a new platform that wouldn't block the bears' paths? How could they avoid destroying the brush the bears use for cover?

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If the area were made safer, more people would come. Where would they park? Photographers worried that if they had to take pictures from a platform, vibrations from people walking would ruin their photographs. The Forest Service came up with a plan. Along the stream, they would build a platform stretching nearly the length of one and a half football fields.

The platform would be from six to twelve feet off the ground so that bears could walk under it. A wide cap atop the railing would give people a place to lean and a steady base for taking pictures. By winding the platform through the trees, the builders could avoid cutting them down.

As a landscape architect with the Forest Service, my husband helped design the viewing platform and oversaw its construction.

Every week, he would return home with tales of the bears he had seen. Our family couldn't wait to see this place!

In August, when we arrived in Hyder, we drove six miles to the viewing area. It was nearly 7 P.M. when we parked the car and walked along the fenced walkway leading from the new, larger parking lot to the platform.

About two hundred people had arrived before us. They lined the platform, watching and chatting. Suddenly the crowd hushed. Someone whispered, "It's The Brat!" I watched as this grizzly caught a big salmon and dragged it up onto the grass.

The best time to watch the bears is in the early morning and evening, but the next day we arrived in the middle of the day and spotted a black bear walking along the stream. Both grizzly and black bears feed here, but black bears usually come when grizzlies aren't around. We heard that a well-known grizzly called Aussie was napping near a pond on the other side of the platform. We waited to see if he would appear. Before long a snout pushed through the brush. Aussie stepped off the bank and into the pond. Only his head showed as he paddled. Reaching the muddy shallows, he turned onto his side and batted at a nearby log. Rolling over, he swam toward the old dike road, where people used to gather. Water droplets glistened on his fur as he climbed out and padded down the road.

Cameras clicked furiously. Turning left, Aussie walked under the platform. I lost sight of him until he waded into the stream. Water sprayed in white plumes as salmon flipped out of his way. Aussie pounced, pinning a salmon against the gravel with his massive paw.

He carried the squirming salmon in his mouth to the opposite shore. After dropping the salmon in the grass, he pushed down on its belly with one paw. Reddish streams of fish eggs spurted out. Aussie left the salmon and licked the tasty roe off the grass and gravel.

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Aussie continued eating his lunch as dozens of people watched. He never looked up at us looking down at him. Did he know we were there? I don’t know, but I was glad he could fish in peace while we watched in safety from the new viewing platform.

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#11 - 37165

Read this paragraph from the text.

The best time to watch the bears is in the early morning and evening, but the next day we arrived in the middle of the day and spotted a black bear walking along the stream. Both grizzly and black bears feed here, but black bears usually come when grizzlies aren't around. We heard that a well-known grizzly called Aussie was napping near a pond on the other side of the platform. We waited to see if he would appear. Before long a snout pushed through the brush. Aussie stepped off the bank and into the pond. Only his head showed as he paddled. Reaching the muddy shallows, he turned onto his side and batted at a nearby log. Rolling over, he swam toward the old dike road, where people used to gather. Water droplets glistened on his fur as he climbed out and padded down the road.

Summarize the main idea of this paragraph. Use key details from the text to support your summary.

#12 - 182867

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Read the passage and answer the questions.

James Watt and the Teakettle
by James Baldwin

A little boy from Scotland was sitting in his grandmother's kitchen. He was watching the red flames in the wide open fireplace and quietly wondering about the causes of things. Indeed, he was always wondering and always wanting to know.

"Grandma," he presently asked, "what makes the fire burn?"

This was not the first time he had puzzled his grandmother with questions that she could not answer. So she went on with her preparations for supper and paid no heed to his query.

Above the fire an old-fashioned teakettle was hanging. The water within it was beginning to bubble. A thin cloud of steam was rising from the spout. Soon the lid began to rattle and shake. The hot vapor puffed out at a furious rate. Yet when the lad peeped under the lid he could see nothing.

"Grandma, what is in the teakettle?" he asked.

"Water, my child—nothing but water."

"But I know there is something else. There is something in there that lifts the lid and makes it rattle."

The grandmother laughed. "Oh, that is only steam," she said. "You can see it coming out of the spout and puffing up under the lid."

"But you said there was nothing but water in the kettle. How did the steam get under the lid?"

"Why, my dear, it comes out of the hot water. The hot water makes it." The grandmother was beginning to feel puzzled.

The lad lifted the lid and peeped inside again. He could see nothing but the bubbling water. The steam was not visible until after it was fairly out of the kettle.

"How odd!" he said. "The steam must be very strong to lift the heavy iron lid. Grandma, how much water did you put into the kettle?"

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"About a quart, Jamie."

"Well, if the steam from so little water is so strong, why would not the steam from a great deal of water be a great deal stronger? Why couldn't it be made to lift a much greater weight? Why couldn't it be made to turn wheels?"

The grandmother made no reply. These questions of Jamie's were more puzzling than profitable, she thought. She went about her work silently, and Jamie sat still in his place and studied the teakettle.

How to understand the power that is in steam, and how to make it do other things than rattle the lids of teakettles—that was the problem which James Watt, the inquisitive Scottish boy, set himself to solve. Day after day he thought about it, and evening after evening he sat by his grandmother's fireside and watched the thin, white vapor come out of the teakettle and lose itself in the yawning black throat of the chimney. The idea grew with him as he grew into manhood, and by long study he began to reason upon it to some purpose.

"There is a wonderful power in steam," he said to himself. "There was never a giant who had so much strength. If we only knew how to harness that power, there is no end to the things it might do for us. It would not only lift weights, but it would turn all kinds of machinery. It would draw our wagons, it would push our ships, it would plow and sow, it would spin and weave. For thousands of years men have been working alongside of this power, never dreaming that it might be made their servant. But how can this be done? That is the question."

He tried one experiment after another. He failed again and again, but from each failure he learned something new. Men laughed at him. "How ridiculous," they said, "to think that steam can be made to run machinery!"

But James Watt persevered, and in the end was able to give to the world the first successful form of the steam engine. Thus, from the study of so simple a thing as a common teakettle, the most useful of all modern inventions was finally produced.

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#12 - 182867

Read the sentence from the text.

Day after day he thought about it, and evening after evening he sat by his grandmother's fireside and watched the thin, white vapor come out of the teakettle and lose itself in the yawning black throat of the chimney.

What effect does the author create by using the phrase yawning black throat of the chimney?

A. It gives the feeling that steam is very important.

B. It gives the feeling that the chimney is very dark and frightening.

C. It gives the feeling of being tired and sleepy.

D. It gives the feeling that the chimney is very large and wide and swallows the steam.

#13 - 37163

Read the text and answer the questions.

Let the Bears Fish
by Carolyn Short

People come to Hyder, Alaska, every summer just as the salmon arrive to lay their eggs on the gravelly stream bottom and die. The bears come to feed on the spawning salmon and to put on the weight they need to survive the winter. The people come to watch the bears. But visitors haven't always had a safe viewing platform. In the past, there was only a short, unprotected platform. To get to it, people had to walk along the bears' paths. Sometimes the bears climbed onto the platform. Over the years, the number of visitors grew. They didn't all fit on the platform, so they wandered everywhere. Since the bears wandered everywhere, too, many visitors were in danger. The Forest Service hired people to keep the visitors and bears apart.

But there were still problems. Many visitors didn't realize that bears are wild animals. Some brought food. Others got too close when they took pictures. Some set up chairs on the bears' paths.

Watching people watching bears turned into one big headache. What could be done?

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How could the Forest Service provide a safe place for bears to fish while people watched? How could they build a new platform that wouldn't block the bears' paths? How could they avoid destroying the brush the bears use for cover?

If the area were made safer, more people would come. Where would they park? Photographers worried that if they had to take pictures from a platform, vibrations from people walking would ruin their photographs. The Forest Service came up with a plan. Along the stream, they would build a platform stretching nearly the length of one and a half football fields.

The platform would be from six to twelve feet off the ground so that bears could walk under it. A wide cap atop the railing would give people a place to lean and a steady base for taking pictures. By winding the platform through the trees, the builders could avoid cutting them down.

As a landscape architect with the Forest Service, my husband helped design the viewing platform and oversaw its construction.

Every week, he would return home with tales of the bears he had seen. Our family couldn't wait to see this place!

In August, when we arrived in Hyder, we drove six miles to the viewing area. It was nearly 7 P.M. when we parked the car and walked along the fenced walkway leading from the new, larger parking lot to the platform.

About two hundred people had arrived before us. They lined the platform, watching and chatting. Suddenly the crowd hushed. Someone whispered, "It's The Brat!" I watched as this grizzly caught a big salmon and dragged it up onto the grass.

The best time to watch the bears is in the early morning and evening, but the next day we arrived in the middle of the day and spotted a black bear walking along the stream. Both grizzly and black bears feed here, but black bears usually come when grizzlies aren't around. We heard that a well-known grizzly called Aussie was napping near a pond on the other side of the platform. We waited to see if he would appear. Before long a snout pushed through the brush. Aussie stepped off the bank and into the pond. Only his head showed as he paddled. Reaching the muddy shallows, he turned onto his side and batted at a nearby log. Rolling over, he swam toward the old dike road, where people used to gather. Water droplets glistened on his fur as he climbed out and padded down the road.

Cameras clicked furiously. Turning left, Aussie walked under the platform. I lost sight of him until he waded into the stream. Water sprayed in white plumes as salmon flipped out of his way. Aussie pounced, pinning a salmon against the gravel with his massive paw.

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He carried the squirming salmon in his mouth to the opposite shore. After dropping the salmon in the grass, he pushed down on its belly with one paw. Reddish streams of fish eggs spurted out. Aussie left the salmon and licked the tasty roe off the grass and gravel.

Aussie continued eating his lunch as dozens of people watched. He never looked up at us looking down at him. Did he know we were there? I don’t know, but I was glad he could fish in peace while we watched in safety from the new viewing platform.

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#13 - 37163

The following question has two parts. First, answer part A. Then, answer part B.

Part A

Read this paragraph from the text and the questions that follow.

Aussie continued eating his lunch as dozens of people watched. He never looked up at us looking down at him. Did he know we were there? I don't know, but I was glad he could fish in peace while we watched in safety from the new viewing platform.

What is the main idea of the paragraph?

Part A

A. People were a distraction to Aussie the bear as he ate.

B. Aussie the bear didn't mind that people were watching him eat.

C. Aussie the bear was unaware that people were watching him eat.

D. People can now watch the bears fish from the safety of the viewing platform.

Part B

Which sentence from the paragraph **best** supports the answer you chose in part A?

Part B

A. “Aussie continued eating his lunch as dozens of people watched.”

B. “He never looked up at us looking down at him.”

C. “Did he know we were there?”

D. “I don't know, but I was glad he could fish in peace while we watched in safety from the new viewing platform.”

#14 - 54964 , #15 - 55297

Read the text and answer the question.

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Mouse and Tapir
A story from South America

Every day Tapir would go off into the forest for hours at a time. Sometimes when she returned, she smelled like something sweet. Other times she would burp. Mouse began to get suspicious and called a meeting of all the other animals and birds.

"Tapir's finding something good to eat, and she's not sharing it with us," said Mouse.

"We'll follow her tomorrow," someone suggested.

"Mouse should go alone," said someone else. "He's the smallest. Tapir won't see him." So it was decided.

When Tapir set off into the forest the next morning, Mouse scurried quietly after her. After a very long walk, Mouse saw Tapir enter a clearing. When Mouse got closer, he couldn't believe his eyes. In the middle of the clearing was an enormous tree, the biggest tree in the world. It had hundreds of huge branches, and each branch was heavy with foods Mouse had never seen before—ripe bananas and plantains, mangoes and papayas, squashes and corn, pumpkins and pomegranates, sweet potatoes and yams—all kinds of edible things. It was the Food Tree.

And there was Tapir, greedily eating the ripe fruits that had fallen to the ground.

Mouse hurried back to the village to tell the others what he had discovered. They all stopped what they were doing and followed Mouse to the Food Tree. Tapir was lying at its base, still eating. Even her chin hairs were dripping with juice.

"Why didn't you tell us about this tree?" asked Mouse. But Tapir didn't answer. She just grunted.

Most of the food was too high to reach, so everyone gathered in a circle to decide what to do. They had no choice but to cut down the tree. They began right away, the birds pecking with their beaks and the animals digging with their claws and gnawing with their teeth at the massive trunk. Tapir didn't help at all. She was too full to move.

Finally, after two whole days and two whole nights of work, the Food Tree swayed for a moment, then tottered. There was a deafening

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crunch as the Food Tree began to fall. Broken branches laden with fruit came tumbling down. When the gigantic trunk hit the ground, the whole world shook.

After everything had settled, the birds and animals gathered again. Mouse noticed that where a banana branch had fallen, several banana trees had sprouted in the ground. Banana trees had never existed before. Tapir pointed out some corn growing a short distance away. There had never been corn plants before. Fruits and vegetables that had never grown anywhere but on the Food Tree were suddenly growing everywhere.

The fruits of the Food Tree still grow to this very day, food for all the animals and people of the world.

"Mouse and Tapir" by Jan Thornhill from *Folktales and Animal Legends from Around the World*. Copyright © 1993 Maple Tree Press.

#14 - 54964

Read the paragraph from the text.

After everything had settled, the birds and animals gathered again. Mouse noticed that where a banana branch had fallen, several banana trees had sprouted in the ground. Banana trees had never existed before. Tapir pointed out some corn growing a short distance away. There had never been corn plants before. Fruits and vegetables that had never grown anywhere but on the Food Tree were suddenly growing everywhere.

Pick the statement that **best** explains why the author chose to include this paragraph.

A. to convince the reader to plant a tree to help animals

B. to inform the reader about the types of plants that grow in the forest

C. to give an explanation to the reader about how something came to be

D. to provide the reader with opinions the characters have about the meeting

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#15 - 55297

What is the antonym of the word suspicious as it is used in paragraph 1 of the text?

A. adventurous

B. annoyed

C. cautious

D. confident

#16 - 182847 , #17 - 182845

Read the text and answer the questions.

Cuisine and Etiquette

by the Peace Corps

Cuisine and Etiquette in Zambia

Zambia's staple food is maize (corn), and Zambians eat maize in several ways. When the corn is ripe but still green, it can be roasted or boiled. When it is dry and hard, it can be fried or boiled. It can also be pounded slightly to remove the outside layer and boiled either by itself or mixed with beans or groundnuts (peanuts). At times the maize is ground to a size a little bigger than rice and is cooked like rice. Finally, we have the fine cornmeal, which is called mealie-meal in Zambia. This is used for making nsima, the most popular meal. Nsima is steamed cornmeal.

Meat from cows, goats, sheep, and fish is used in sauces over nsima. There are also a lot of vegetables put in sauces, such as leaves from beans, okra, cow peas, pumpkins, and cassava. Other vegetables eaten almost daily include onions and tomatoes.

All the cooking is done by the wife. Nsima is usually prepared for lunch and dinner and not for breakfast. In a traditional setting, boys from the age of seven eat with the man of the house.

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The mother eats with the girls and the younger boys. This is because all of the children below the age of seven are under the guidance of their mother. Almost all learning takes place through daily activities in the home. The mother, who is in charge of the kids' learning, has to take care of their learning at meal time. This is changing, especially in towns and cities. The trend now is that members of the family all eat together.

Before eating, everybody washes hands in order of the status of the members of the family: father first, then mother, and others follow according to their ages. One of the younger children, boy or girl, passes a water dish around for others to wash their hands. If a visitor happens to have a meal with the family, he or she is given the honor of washing first.

It is rude to talk very much or loudly while eating. After eating, the family members wash their hands again in the same order. The wife and the young ones clear the table. Belching after a meal used to be a compliment, but it is not nowadays.

Cuisine and Etiquette in Uganda

In Uganda, the staple food is matoke (cooking bananas). Other food crops include cassava (manioc), sweet potatoes, white potatoes, yams, beans, peas, groundnuts (peanuts), cabbage, onions, pumpkins, and tomatoes. Some fruits, such as oranges, pawpaws (papayas), lemons, and pineapples, are also grown.

Most people, except for a few who live in the city centers, produce their own food. The responsibility for preparing the family's meals belongs solely to women and girls in the home. Men and boys of age 12 and above are not even expected to sit in the kitchen, which is separate from the main house. Cooking is done on an open fire using wood for fuel.

Most families eat two meals a day. The two meals are lunch and supper. Breakfast is just a cup of tea or a bowl of porridge.

When a meal is ready, all members of the household wash their hands and sit down on [floor] mats. Hands have to be washed before and after the meal because most Ugandans eat with their hands. At mealtime everybody is welcome; visitors and neighbors who drop in are expected to join the family at a meal.

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Food is served by women. They cut it up into small pieces for each member of the family. Sauce, which is usually a stew with vegetables, beans, butter, salt, and curry powder, is served to each person on a plate. Sometimes fish or beef stew is served.

Normally a short prayer is said before the family starts eating. During the meal, children talk only when asked a question. It is bad manners to reach for salt or a spoon. It is better to ask someone sitting close to it to pass it. It is also bad manners to leave the room while others are still eating. Everyone respects the meal by staying seated until the meal is over. Leaning on the left hand or stretching ones legs while at a meal is a sign of disrespect and is not tolerated.

People usually drink water at the end of the meal. It is considered odd to drink water while eating.

When the meal is finished, everyone in turn gives a compliment to the mother by saying, "Thank you for preparing the meal, madam." No dessert is served after the meal. Fruits like papaw, pineapple, or sweet bananas are normally eaten as a snack between meals.

Excerpt from "Worldwise Window" by the Peace Corps. In the public domain.

#16 - 182847

The author used the contrast in roles of males and females in “Cuisine and Etiquette in Uganda” to stress the importance of social structure. What does the author's use of contrast in describing the roles of males and females in “Cuisine and Etiquette in Zambia” tell the reader about the importance of social structure in that country?

A. The contrast of roles shares insight into the cultural structure.

B. The contrast of roles explains the education process of the children.

C. The contrast of roles clarifies the order of hand washing in that country.

D. The contrast of roles explains that women do not have the same rights in all countries.

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#17 - 182845

How might have the information in “Cuisine and Etiquette in Zambia” affected the way “Cuisine and Etiquette in Uganda” is written?

A. The author kept all of the information in one paragraph for each text to make it easier to read.

B. The author used food preferences in the introduction of each text to explain that country's diet.

C. The author kept each text short as a way of focusing only on the cuisine and etiquette of both countries.

D. The author introduced specific food used by each country as a lead in to explain the cultures of the two countries.

#18 - 37177 , #19 - 37977

Read the text and answer the questions.

Let the Bears Fish
by Carolyn Short

People come to Hyder, Alaska, every summer just as the salmon arrive to lay their eggs on the gravelly stream bottom and die. The bears come to feed on the spawning salmon and to put on the weight they need to survive the winter. The people come to watch the bears. But visitors haven’t always had a safe viewing platform. In the past, there was only a short, unprotected platform. To get to it, people had to walk along the bears’ paths. Sometimes the bears climbed onto the platform. Over the years, the number of visitors grew. They didn’t all fit on the platform, so they wandered everywhere. Since the bears wandered everywhere, too, many visitors were in danger. The Forest Service hired people to keep the visitors and bears apart.

But there were still problems. Many visitors didn’t realize that bears are wild animals. Some brought food. Others got too close when they took pictures. Some set up chairs on the bears’ paths.

Watching people watching bears turned into one big headache. What could be done?

How could the Forest Service provide a safe place for bears to fish while people watched? How could they build a new platform that wouldn’t block the bears’ paths? How could they avoid destroying the brush the bears use for cover?

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If the area were made safer, more people would come. Where would they park? Photographers worried that if they had to take pictures from a platform, vibrations from people walking would ruin their photographs. The Forest Service came up with a plan. Along the stream, they would build a platform stretching nearly the length of one and a half football fields.

The platform would be from six to twelve feet off the ground so that bears could walk under it. A wide cap atop the railing would give people a place to lean and a steady base for taking pictures. By winding the platform through the trees, the builders could avoid cutting them down.

As a landscape architect with the Forest Service, my husband helped design the viewing platform and oversaw its construction.

Every week, he would return home with tales of the bears he had seen. Our family couldn't wait to see this place!

In August, when we arrived in Hyder, we drove six miles to the viewing area. It was nearly 7 P.M. when we parked the car and walked along the fenced walkway leading from the new, larger parking lot to the platform.

About two hundred people had arrived before us. They lined the platform, watching and chatting. Suddenly the crowd hushed. Someone whispered, "It's The Brat!" I watched as this grizzly caught a big salmon and dragged it up onto the grass.

The best time to watch the bears is in the early morning and evening, but the next day we arrived in the middle of the day and spotted a black bear walking along the stream. Both grizzly and black bears feed here, but black bears usually come when grizzlies aren't around. We heard that a well-known grizzly called Aussie was napping near a pond on the other side of the platform. We waited to see if he would appear. Before long a snout pushed through the brush. Aussie stepped off the bank and into the pond. Only his head showed as he paddled. Reaching the muddy shallows, he turned onto his side and batted at a nearby log. Rolling over, he swam toward the old dike road, where people used to gather. Water droplets glistened on his fur as he climbed out and padded down the road.

Cameras clicked furiously. Turning left, Aussie walked under the platform. I lost sight of him until he waded into the stream. Water sprayed in white plumes as salmon flipped out of his way. Aussie pounced, pinning a salmon against the gravel with his massive paw.

He carried the squirming salmon in his mouth to the opposite shore. After dropping the salmon in the grass, he pushed down on its belly with one paw. Reddish streams of fish eggs spurted out. Aussie left the salmon and licked the tasty roe off the grass and gravel.

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Aussie continued eating his lunch as dozens of people watched. He never looked up at us looking down at him. Did he know we were there? I don't know, but I was glad he could fish in peace while we watched in safety from the new viewing platform.

"Let the Bears Fish" by Carolyn Short, from *Highlights for Children*. Copyright © 2004 by Highlights for Children, Inc. Reprinted by permission of the publisher.

#18 - 37177

Read the sentence from the text.

<u>Watching people watching bears</u> turned into one big headache.

What does the phrase "Watching people watching bears" suggest about the author's point of view in the text? Select **three** that are correct.

A. The author thinks that watching bears is boring.

B. The author thinks that people should not watch bears.

C. The author thinks that the way people were watching the bears was dangerous.

D. The author thinks that people were getting in the bears' way while watching them.

E. The author believes that people were getting sick from watching the bears in the cold.

F. The author believes that people should not put themselves in harm's way in order to watch bears.

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#19 - 37977

Read the paragraph from the text and answer the question.

People come to Hyder, Alaska, every summer just as the salmon arrive to lay their eggs on the gravelly stream bottom and die. The bears come to feed on the spawning salmon and to put on the weight they need to survive the winter. The people come to watch the bears. But visitors haven't always had a safe viewing platform. In the past, there was only a short, unprotected platform. To get to it, people had to walk along the bears' paths. Sometimes the bears climbed onto the platform. Over the years, the number of visitors grew. They didn't all fit on the platform, so they wandered everywhere. Since the bears wandered everywhere, too, many visitors were in danger. The Forest Service hired people to keep the visitors and bears apart.

What can you infer about the author's point of view on visiting the bears? Use details from the text in your answer.

#20 - 182868

Read the passage and answer the questions.

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James Watt and the Teakettle
by James Baldwin

A little boy from Scotland was sitting in his grandmother's kitchen. He was watching the red flames in the wide open fireplace and quietly wondering about the causes of things. Indeed, he was always wondering and always wanting to know.

"Grandma," he presently asked, "what makes the fire burn?"

This was not the first time he had puzzled his grandmother with questions that she could not answer. So she went on with her preparations for supper and paid no heed to his query.

Above the fire an old-fashioned teakettle was hanging. The water within it was beginning to bubble. A thin cloud of steam was rising from the spout. Soon the lid began to rattle and shake. The hot vapor puffed out at a furious rate. Yet when the lad peeped under the lid he could see nothing.

"Grandma, what is in the teakettle?" he asked.

"Water, my child—nothing but water."

"But I know there is something else. There is something in there that lifts the lid and makes it rattle."

The grandmother laughed. "Oh, that is only steam," she said. "You can see it coming out of the spout and puffing up under the lid."

"But you said there was nothing but water in the kettle. How did the steam get under the lid?"

"Why, my dear, it comes out of the hot water. The hot water makes it." The grandmother was beginning to feel puzzled.

The lad lifted the lid and peeped inside again. He could see nothing but the bubbling water. The steam was not visible until after it was fairly out of the kettle.

"How odd!" he said. "The steam must be very strong to lift the heavy iron lid. Grandma, how much water did you put into the kettle?"

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"About a quart, Jamie."

"Well, if the steam from so little water is so strong, why would not the steam from a great deal of water be a great deal stronger? Why couldn't it be made to lift a much greater weight? Why couldn't it be made to turn wheels?"

The grandmother made no reply. These questions of Jamie's were more puzzling than profitable, she thought. She went about her work silently, and Jamie sat still in his place and studied the teakettle.

How to understand the power that is in steam, and how to make it do other things than rattle the lids of teakettles—that was the problem which James Watt, the inquisitive Scottish boy, set himself to solve. Day after day he thought about it, and evening after evening he sat by his grandmother's fireside and watched the thin, white vapor come out of the teakettle and lose itself in the yawning black throat of the chimney. The idea grew with him as he grew into manhood, and by long study he began to reason upon it to some purpose.

"There is a wonderful power in steam," he said to himself. "There was never a giant who had so much strength. If we only knew how to harness that power, there is no end to the things it might do for us. It would not only lift weights, but it would turn all kinds of machinery. It would draw our wagons, it would push our ships, it would plow and sow, it would spin and weave. For thousands of years men have been working alongside of this power, never dreaming that it might be made their servant. But how can this be done? That is the question."

He tried one experiment after another. He failed again and again, but from each failure he learned something new. Men laughed at him. "How ridiculous," they said, "to think that steam can be made to run machinery!"

But James Watt persevered, and in the end was able to give to the world the first successful form of the steam engine. Thus, from the study of so simple a thing as a common teakettle, the most useful of all modern inventions was finally produced.

"James Watt and the Teakettle" by James Baldwin from *Thirty More Famous Stories*. In the public domain.

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#20 - 182868

Read the sentence from the text.

The hot vapor puffed out at a furious rate.

What does the word furious suggest about the steam? Pick **two** choices.

A. The steam was quite noisy.

B. The steam came out very fast.

C. The steam made James angry.

D. The steam caused James to yell.

E. The steam appeared to be powerful.

F. The steam created a lot of excitement.

#21 - 182837

Read the text and answer the questions.

Cuisine and Etiquette

by the Peace Corps

Cuisine and Etiquette in Zambia

Zambia's staple food is maize (corn), and Zambians eat maize in several ways. When the corn is ripe but still green, it can be roasted or boiled. When it is dry and hard, it can be fried or boiled. It can also be pounded slightly to remove the outside layer and boiled either by itself or mixed with beans or groundnuts (peanuts). At times the maize is ground to a size a little bigger than rice and is cooked like rice. Finally, we have the fine cornmeal, which is called mealie-meal in Zambia. This is used for making nsima, the most popular meal. Nsima is steamed cornmeal.

Meat from cows, goats, sheep, and fish is used in sauces over nsima. There are also a lot of vegetables put in sauces, such as leaves from beans, okra, cow peas, pumpkins, and cassava. Other vegetables

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eaten almost daily include onions and tomatoes.

All the cooking is done by the wife. Nsima is usually prepared for lunch and dinner and not for breakfast. In a traditional setting, boys from the age of seven eat with the man of the house.

The mother eats with the girls and the younger boys. This is because all of the children below the age of seven are under the guidance of their mother. Almost all learning takes place through daily activities in the home. The mother, who is in charge of the kids' learning, has to take care of their learning at meal time. This is changing, especially in towns and cities. The trend now is that members of the family all eat together.

Before eating, everybody washes hands in order of the status of the members of the family: father first, then mother, and others follow according to their ages. One of the younger children, boy or girl, passes a water dish around for others to wash their hands. If a visitor happens to have a meal with the family, he or she is given the honor of washing first.

It is rude to talk very much or loudly while eating. After eating, the family members wash their hands again in the same order. The wife and the young ones clear the table. Belching after a meal used to be a compliment, but it is not nowadays.

Cuisine and Etiquette in Uganda

In Uganda, the staple food is matoke (cooking bananas). Other food crops include cassava (manioc), sweet potatoes, white potatoes, yams, beans, peas, groundnuts (peanuts), cabbage, onions, pumpkins, and tomatoes. Some fruits, such as oranges, pawpaws (papayas), lemons, and pineapples, are also grown.

Most people, except for a few who live in the city centers, produce their own food. The responsibility for preparing the family's meals belongs solely to women and girls in the home. Men and boys of age 12 and above are not even expected to sit in the kitchen, which is separate from the main house. Cooking is done on an open fire using wood for fuel.

Most families eat two meals a day. The two meals are lunch and supper. Breakfast is just a cup of tea or a bowl of porridge.

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When a meal is ready, all members of the household wash their hands and sit down on [floor] mats. Hands have to be washed before and after the meal because most Ugandans eat with their hands. At mealtime everybody is welcome; visitors and neighbors who drop in are expected to join the family at a meal.

Food is served by women. They cut it up into small pieces for each member of the family. Sauce, which is usually a stew with vegetables, beans, butter, salt, and curry powder, is served to each person on a plate. Sometimes fish or beef stew is served.

Normally a short prayer is said before the family starts eating. During the meal, children talk only when asked a question. It is bad manners to reach for salt or a spoon. It is better to ask someone sitting close to it to pass it. It is also bad manners to leave the room while others are still eating. Everyone respects the meal by staying seated until the meal is over. Leaning on the left hand or stretching ones legs while at a meal is a sign of disrespect and is not tolerated.

People usually drink water at the end of the meal. It is considered odd to drink water while eating.

When the meal is finished, everyone in turn gives a compliment to the mother by saying, "Thank you for preparing the meal, madam." No dessert is served after the meal. Fruits like papaw, pineapple, or sweet bananas are normally eaten as a snack between meals.

Excerpt from "Worldwise Window" by the Peace Corps. In the public domain.

#21 - 182837

Which detail from “Cuisine and Etiquette in Zambia” **best** shows that the father is at the top of the social structure in a family?

A. In a traditional setting, boys from the age of seven eat with the man of the house.

B. This is because all of the children below the age of seven are under the guidance of their mother.

C. The mother eats with the girls and the younger boys.

D. Before eating, everybody washes hands in order of the status of the members of the family: father first, then mother, and others follow according to their ages.

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Read the text and answer the questions.

Let the Bears Fish
by Carolyn Short

People come to Hyder, Alaska, every summer just as the salmon arrive to lay their eggs on the gravelly stream bottom and die. The bears come to feed on the spawning salmon and to put on the weight they need to survive the winter. The people come to watch the bears. But visitors haven't always had a safe viewing platform. In the past, there was only a short, unprotected platform. To get to it, people had to walk along the bears' paths. Sometimes the bears climbed onto the platform. Over the years, the number of visitors grew. They didn't all fit on the platform, so they wandered everywhere. Since the bears wandered everywhere, too, many visitors were in danger. The Forest Service hired people to keep the visitors and bears apart.

But there were still problems. Many visitors didn't realize that bears are wild animals. Some brought food. Others got too close when they took pictures. Some set up chairs on the bears' paths.

Watching people watching bears turned into one big headache. What could be done?

How could the Forest Service provide a safe place for bears to fish while people watched? How could they build a new platform that wouldn't block the bears' paths? How could they avoid destroying the brush the bears use for cover?

If the area were made safer, more people would come. Where would they park? Photographers worried that if they had to take pictures from a platform, vibrations from people walking would ruin their photographs. The Forest Service came up with a plan. Along the stream, they would build a platform stretching nearly the length of one and a half football fields.

The platform would be from six to twelve feet off the ground so that bears could walk under it. A wide cap atop the railing would give people a place to lean and a steady base for taking pictures. By winding the platform through the trees, the builders could avoid cutting them down.

As a landscape architect with the Forest Service, my husband helped design the viewing platform and oversaw its construction.

Every week, he would return home with tales of the bears he had seen. Our family couldn't wait to see this place!

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In August, when we arrived in Hyder, we drove six miles to the viewing area. It was nearly 7 P.M. when we parked the car and walked along the fenced walkway leading from the new, larger parking lot to the platform.

About two hundred people had arrived before us. They lined the platform, watching and chatting. Suddenly the crowd hushed. Someone whispered, “It’s The Brat!” I watched as this grizzly caught a big salmon and dragged it up onto the grass.

The best time to watch the bears is in the early morning and evening, but the next day we arrived in the middle of the day and spotted a black bear walking along the stream. Both grizzly and black bears feed here, but black bears usually come when grizzlies aren’t around. We heard that a well-known grizzly called Aussie was napping near a pond on the other side of the platform. We waited to see if he would appear. Before long a snout pushed through the brush. Aussie stepped off the bank and into the pond. Only his head showed as he paddled. Reaching the muddy shallows, he turned onto his side and batted at a nearby log. Rolling over, he swam toward the old dike road, where people used to gather. Water droplets glistened on his fur as he climbed out and padded down the road.

Cameras clicked furiously. Turning left, Aussie walked under the platform. I lost sight of him until he waded into the stream. Water sprayed in white plumes as salmon flipped out of his way. Aussie pounced, pinning a salmon against the gravel with his massive paw.

He carried the squirming salmon in his mouth to the opposite shore. After dropping the salmon in the grass, he pushed down on its belly with one paw. Reddish streams of fish eggs spurted out. Aussie left the salmon and licked the tasty roe off the grass and gravel.

Aussie continued eating his lunch as dozens of people watched. He never looked up at us looking down at him. Did he know we were there? I don’t know, but I was glad he could fish in peace while we watched in safety from the new viewing platform.

"Let the Bears Fish" by Carolyn Short, from *Highlights for Children*. Copyright © 2004 by Highlights for Children, Inc. Reprinted by permission of the publisher.

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#22 - 37175

What effect does the change from **third** person to **first** person point of view have on the reader's understanding of the text?

A. It shows the reader that the text is nonfiction.

B. It makes the author appear more knowledgeable to the reader.

C. It distracts the reader from focusing on the problem of building a platform.

D. It helps the reader understand the personal connection the author has to the story.

#23 - 182839

Read the text and answer the questions.

Cuisine and Etiquette

by the Peace Corps

Cuisine and Etiquette in Zambia

Zambia's staple food is maize (corn), and Zambians eat maize in several ways. When the corn is ripe but still green, it can be roasted or boiled. When it is dry and hard, it can be fried or boiled. It can also be pounded slightly to remove the outside layer and boiled either by itself or mixed with beans or groundnuts (peanuts). At times the maize is ground to a size a little bigger than rice and is cooked like rice. Finally, we have the fine cornmeal, which is called mealie-meal in Zambia. This is used for making nsima, the most popular meal. Nsima is steamed cornmeal.

Meat from cows, goats, sheep, and fish is used in sauces over nsima. There are also a lot of vegetables put in sauces, such as leaves from beans, okra, cow peas, pumpkins, and cassava. Other vegetables eaten almost daily include onions and tomatoes.

All the cooking is done by the wife. Nsima is usually prepared for lunch and dinner and not for breakfast. In a traditional setting, boys from the age of seven eat with the man of the house.

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The mother eats with the girls and the younger boys. This is because all of the children below the age of seven are under the guidance of their mother. Almost all learning takes place through daily activities in the home. The mother, who is in charge of the kids' learning, has to take care of their learning at meal time. This is changing, especially in towns and cities. The trend now is that members of the family all eat together.

Before eating, everybody washes hands in order of the status of the members of the family: father first, then mother, and others follow according to their ages. One of the younger children, boy or girl, passes a water dish around for others to wash their hands. If a visitor happens to have a meal with the family, he or she is given the honor of washing first.

It is rude to talk very much or loudly while eating. After eating, the family members wash their hands again in the same order. The wife and the young ones clear the table. Belching after a meal used to be a compliment, but it is not nowadays.

Cuisine and Etiquette in Uganda

In Uganda, the staple food is matoke (cooking bananas). Other food crops include cassava (manioc), sweet potatoes, white potatoes, yams, beans, peas, groundnuts (peanuts), cabbage, onions, pumpkins, and tomatoes. Some fruits, such as oranges, pawpaws (papayas), lemons, and pineapples, are also grown.

Most people, except for a few who live in the city centers, produce their own food. The responsibility for preparing the family's meals belongs solely to women and girls in the home. Men and boys of age 12 and above are not even expected to sit in the kitchen, which is separate from the main house. Cooking is done on an open fire using wood for fuel.

Most families eat two meals a day. The two meals are lunch and supper. Breakfast is just a cup of tea or a bowl of porridge.

When a meal is ready, all members of the household wash their hands and sit down on [floor] mats. Hands have to be washed before and after the meal because most Ugandans eat with their hands. At mealtime everybody is welcome; visitors and neighbors who drop in are expected to join the family at a meal.

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Food is served by women. They cut it up into small pieces for each member of the family. Sauce, which is usually a stew with vegetables, beans, butter, salt, and curry powder, is served to each person on a plate. Sometimes fish or beef stew is served.

Normally a short prayer is said before the family starts eating. During the meal, children talk only when asked a question. It is bad manners to reach for salt or a spoon. It is better to ask someone sitting close to it to pass it. It is also bad manners to leave the room while others are still eating. Everyone respects the meal by staying seated until the meal is over. Leaning on the left hand or stretching ones legs while at a meal is a sign of disrespect and is not tolerated.

People usually drink water at the end of the meal. It is considered odd to drink water while eating.

When the meal is finished, everyone in turn gives a compliment to the mother by saying, "Thank you for preparing the meal, madam." No dessert is served after the meal. Fruits like papaw, pineapple, or sweet bananas are normally eaten as a snack between meals.

Excerpt from "Worldwise Window" by the Peace Corps. In the public domain.

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#23 - 182839

The following question has two parts. First, answer part A. Then, answer part B.

What main idea can be found in **both** "Cuisine and Etiquette in Zambia" and "Cuisine and Etiquette in Uganda"?

Part A

A. Mealtime customs are important in both cultures.

B. Women are responsible for all of the meal preparation.

C. Hand washing is necessary to meal preparation in both cultures.

D. Men are not expected to participate in the mealtime preparation.

Which sentences from "Cuisine and Etiquette in Zambia" **best** support your answer in part A? Select **two** options.

Part B

A. "When the corn is ripe but still green, it can be roasted or boiled. When it is dry and hard, it can be fried or boiled."

B. "In a traditional setting, boys from the age of seven eat with the man of the house."

C. "Almost all learning takes place through daily activities in the home."

D. "The trend now is that members of the family all eat together."

E. "Before eating, everybody washes hands in order of the status of the members of the family: father first, then mother, and others follow according to their ages."

#24 - 182879

Read the passage and answer the questions.

James Watt and the Teakettle
by James Baldwin

A little boy from Scotland was sitting in his grandmother's kitchen. He was watching the red flames in the wide open fireplace and quietly

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wondering about the causes of things. Indeed, he was always wondering and always wanting to know.

"Grandma," he presently asked, "what makes the fire burn?"

This was not the first time he had puzzled his grandmother with questions that she could not answer. So she went on with her preparations for supper and paid no heed to his query.

Above the fire an old-fashioned teakettle was hanging. The water within it was beginning to bubble. A thin cloud of steam was rising from the spout. Soon the lid began to rattle and shake. The hot vapor puffed out at a furious rate. Yet when the lad peeped under the lid he could see nothing.

"Grandma, what is in the teakettle?" he asked.

"Water, my child—nothing but water."

"But I know there is something else. There is something in there that lifts the lid and makes it rattle."

The grandmother laughed. "Oh, that is only steam," she said. "You can see it coming out of the spout and puffing up under the lid."

"But you said there was nothing but water in the kettle. How did the steam get under the lid?"

"Why, my dear, it comes out of the hot water. The hot water makes it." The grandmother was beginning to feel puzzled.

The lad lifted the lid and peeped inside again. He could see nothing but the bubbling water. The steam was not visible until after it was fairly out of the kettle.

"How odd!" he said. "The steam must be very strong to lift the heavy iron lid. Grandma, how much water did you put into the kettle?"

"About a quart, Jamie."

"Well, if the steam from so little water is so strong, why would not the steam from a great deal of water be a great deal stronger? Why couldn't it be made to lift a much greater weight? Why couldn't it be made to turn wheels?"

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The grandmother made no reply. These questions of Jamie's were more puzzling than profitable, she thought. She went about her work silently, and Jamie sat still in his place and studied the teakettle.

How to understand the power that is in steam, and how to make it do other things than rattle the lids of teakettles—that was the problem which James Watt, the inquisitive Scottish boy, set himself to solve. Day after day he thought about it, and evening after evening he sat by his grandmother's fireside and watched the thin, white vapor come out of the teakettle and lose itself in the yawning black throat of the chimney. The idea grew with him as he grew into manhood, and by long study he began to reason upon it to some purpose.

"There is a wonderful power in steam," he said to himself. "There was never a giant who had so much strength. If we only knew how to harness that power, there is no end to the things it might do for us. It would not only lift weights, but it would turn all kinds of machinery. It would draw our wagons, it would push our ships, it would plow and sow, it would spin and weave. For thousands of years men have been working alongside of this power, never dreaming that it might be made their servant. But how can this be done? That is the question."

He tried one experiment after another. He failed again and again, but from each failure he learned something new. Men laughed at him. "How ridiculous," they said, "to think that steam can be made to run machinery!"

But James Watt persevered, and in the end was able to give to the world the first successful form of the steam engine. Thus, from the study of so simple a thing as a common teakettle, the most useful of all modern inventions was finally produced.

"James Watt and the Teakettle" by James Baldwin from *Thirty More Famous Stories*. In the public domain.

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#24 - 182879

Click on the **two** sentences that **best** show that James Watt formed new ideas for what steam might do to help humans.

"There is a wonderful power in steam," he said to himself. "There was never a giant who had so much strength. If we only knew how to harness that power, there is no end to the things it might do for us. It would not only lift weights, but it would turn all kinds of machinery. It would draw our wagons, it would push our ships, it would plow and sow, it would spin and weave. For thousands of years men have been working alongside of this power, never dreaming that it might be made their servant."

#25 - 37171

Read the text and answer the questions.

Let the Bears Fish
by Carolyn Short

People come to Hyder, Alaska, every summer just as the salmon arrive to lay their eggs on the gravelly stream bottom and die. The bears come to feed on the spawning salmon and to put on the weight they need to survive the winter. The people come to watch the bears. But visitors haven't always had a safe viewing platform. In the past, there was only a short, unprotected platform. To get to it, people had to walk along the bears' paths. Sometimes the bears climbed onto the platform. Over the years, the number of visitors grew. They didn't all fit on the platform, so they wandered everywhere. Since the bears wandered everywhere, too, many visitors were in danger. The Forest Service hired people to keep the visitors and bears apart.

But there were still problems. Many visitors didn't realize that bears are wild animals. Some brought food. Others got too close when they took pictures. Some set up chairs on the bears' paths.

Watching people watching bears turned into one big headache. What could be done?

How could the Forest Service provide a safe place for bears to fish while people watched? How could they build a new platform that wouldn't block the bears' paths? How could they avoid destroying the brush the bears use for cover?

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If the area were made safer, more people would come. Where would they park? Photographers worried that if they had to take pictures from a platform, vibrations from people walking would ruin their photographs. The Forest Service came up with a plan. Along the stream, they would build a platform stretching nearly the length of one and a half football fields.

The platform would be from six to twelve feet off the ground so that bears could walk under it. A wide cap atop the railing would give people a place to lean and a steady base for taking pictures. By winding the platform through the trees, the builders could avoid cutting them down.

As a landscape architect with the Forest Service, my husband helped design the viewing platform and oversaw its construction.

Every week, he would return home with tales of the bears he had seen. Our family couldn't wait to see this place!

In August, when we arrived in Hyder, we drove six miles to the viewing area. It was nearly 7 P.M. when we parked the car and walked along the fenced walkway leading from the new, larger parking lot to the platform.

About two hundred people had arrived before us. They lined the platform, watching and chatting. Suddenly the crowd hushed. Someone whispered, "It's The Brat!" I watched as this grizzly caught a big salmon and dragged it up onto the grass.

The best time to watch the bears is in the early morning and evening, but the next day we arrived in the middle of the day and spotted a black bear walking along the stream. Both grizzly and black bears feed here, but black bears usually come when grizzlies aren't around. We heard that a well-known grizzly called Aussie was napping near a pond on the other side of the platform. We waited to see if he would appear. Before long a snout pushed through the brush. Aussie stepped off the bank and into the pond. Only his head showed as he paddled. Reaching the muddy shallows, he turned onto his side and batted at a nearby log. Rolling over, he swam toward the old dike road, where people used to gather. Water droplets glistened on his fur as he climbed out and padded down the road.

Cameras clicked furiously. Turning left, Aussie walked under the platform. I lost sight of him until he waded into the stream. Water sprayed in white plumes as salmon flipped out of his way. Aussie pounced, pinning a salmon against the gravel with his massive paw.

He carried the squirming salmon in his mouth to the opposite shore. After dropping the salmon in the grass, he pushed down on its belly with one paw. Reddish streams of fish eggs spurted out. Aussie left the salmon and licked the tasty roe off the grass and gravel.

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Aussie continued eating his lunch as dozens of people watched. He never looked up at us looking down at him. Did he know we were there? I don't know, but I was glad he could fish in peace while we watched in safety from the new viewing platform.

"Let the Bears Fish" by Carolyn Short, from *Highlights for Children*. Copyright © 2004 by Highlights for Children, Inc. Reprinted by permission of the publisher.

#25 - 37171

Read the paragraph.

The platform would be from six to twelve feet off the ground so that bears could walk under it. A wide cap atop the railing would give people a place to lean and a steady base for taking pictures. By winding the platform through the trees, the builders could avoid cutting them down.

What does the information in the paragraph show about the author's point of view?

Select **all** that are correct.

A. The author believes it is important to keep the trees.

B. The author wants people to be able to view the bears comfortably.

C. The author thinks the platform will offer advantages for photographers.

D. The author thinks it is important to keep the park as a natural habitat.

E. The author is concerned that people will not like being so far away from the bears.

F. The author thinks that the trees will cause a challenge with the construction of the platform.

#26 - 182871

Read the passage and answer the questions.

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James Watt and the Teakettle
by James Baldwin

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"Well, if the steam from so little water is so strong, why would not the steam from a great deal of water be a great deal stronger? Why couldn't it be made to lift a much greater weight? Why couldn't it be made to turn wheels?"

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What can you infer about the grandmother in paragraph three? Include information from the text in your answer.

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